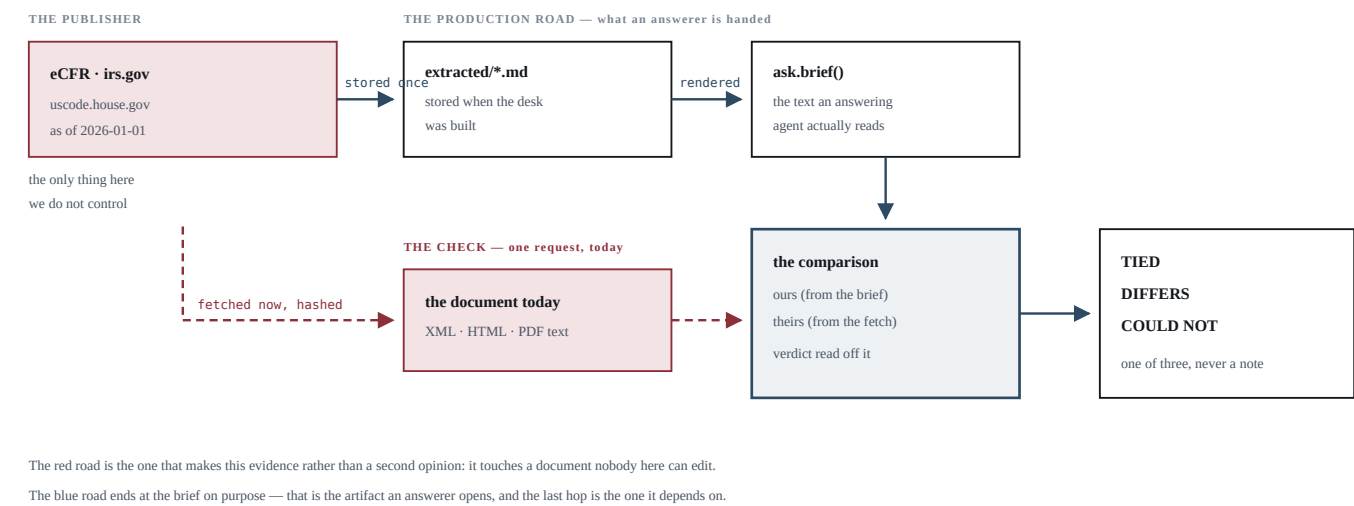


cash-and-bank

Every passage this desk hands to an answering agent, put back to the publisher that wrote it. **The question is not whether our tests pass.** It is whether the authority we serve is what the authority actually says — which no test in this repository can answer, because they all read the same stored files.



The same passage, two roads. They meet at the comparison, and the verdict is read off that block rather than written ahead of it.

The roster

0	0	49 of 49	2
DIFFERS	COULD NOT	TIED	SOURCES FETCHED LIVE

Of the 49 that tied, 43 matched the publisher's characters exactly, 4 matched only once whitespace was ignored, and 2 carry a marked omission and were checked segment by segment, in order. All three are declared, and explained under what this does not prove.

43 + 4 + 2 = 49, which is the tied count above. THE SENTENCE USED TO NAME TWO OF THE THREE and so did not add up — 43 and 4 against 49 tied on the cash desk, with the two marked omissions unaccounted for. A breakdown that does not sum to its own total is the failure this exhibit exists to catch, printed by the exhibit.

The sample of one, worked end to end

The longest passage on this desk, because a long one has the most places to be wrong.

1 · THE FIGURE — AND WHERE A READER SEES IT

Not a row of a database: the paragraph of authority the desk hands an answering agent under the citation IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Supporting Documents". It is read out of ask.brief(), which is the text that agent opens, and it is 6,809 characters long.

Purchases, sales, payroll, and other transactions you have in your business generate supporting documents. Supporting documents include sales slips, paid bills, invoices, receipts, deposit slips, and canceled checks. These documents contain information you need to record in your books. It is important to keep these documents because they support the entries in your books and on your tax return. Keep them in an orderly fashion and in a safe place. For instance, organize them by year and type of income or expense.

Gross receipts. Gross receipts are the income you receive from your business. You should keep supporting documents that show the amounts and sources of your gross receipts. Documents that show gross receipts include the following:

- Cash register tapes.
- Bank deposit slips.
- Receipt books.
- Invoices.
- Credit card charge slips.
- Forms 1099-MISC.
- Forms 1099-NEC.

Inventory. Inventory is any item you buy and resell to customers. If you are a manufacturer or producer, this includes the cost of all raw materials or parts purchased for manufacture into finished products. Your supporting documents should show the amount paid and that the amount was for inventory. Documents reporting the cost of inventory include the following:

- Canceled checks.
- Cash register tape receipts.
- Credit card sales slips.
- Invoices.

These records will help you determine the value of your inventory at the end of the year. See Pub. 538 for information on methods for valuing inventory.

Expenses. Expenses are the costs you incur (other than the cost of inventory) to carry on your business. Your supporting documents should show the amount paid and that the amount was for a business expense. Documents for expenses include the following:

- Canceled checks.
- Cash register tapes.
- Account statements.
- Credit card sales slips.
- Invoices.
- Petty cash slips for small cash payments.

. A petty cash fund allows you to make small payments without having to write checks for small amounts. Each time you make a payment from this fund, you should make out a petty cash slip and attach it to your receipt as proof of payment.

- Travel, transportation, and gift expenses.

Specific recordkeeping rules apply to these expenses. For more information, see Pub. 463.

Employment taxes. There are specific employment tax records you must keep. For a list, see Pub. 15.

Assets. Assets are the property, such as machinery and furniture you own and use in your business. You must keep records to verify certain information about your business assets. You need records to figure the annual depreciation and the gain or loss when you sell the assets. Your records should show the following information:

- When and how you acquired the asset.
- Purchase price.
- Cost of any improvements.
- Section 179 deduction taken.
- Deductions taken for depreciation.
- Deductions taken for casualty losses, such as losses resulting from fires or storms.
- How you used the asset.
- When and how you disposed of the asset.
- Selling price.
- Expenses of sale.

The following documents may show this information:

- Purchase and sales invoices.
- Real estate closing statements.
- Canceled checks.

What if I don't have a canceled check? If you do not have a canceled check, you may be able to prove payment with certain financial account statements prepared by financial institutions. These include account statements prepared for the financial institution by a third party. These account statements must be highly legible. The following table lists acceptable account statements.

IF payment is by...	THEN the statement must show the...
Check	Check number.
Amount.	Payee's name.
Date the check amount was posted to the account by the financial institution.	
Electronic funds transfer	Amount transferred.
Payee's name.	Date the transfer was posted to the account by the financial institution.
Credit card	Amount charged.
Payee's name.	Transaction date.

. Proof of payment of an amount, by itself, does not establish you are entitled to a tax deduction. You should also keep other documents, such as credit card sales slips and invoices, to show that you also incurred the cost.

Recording Business Transactions A good recordkeeping system includes a summary of your business transactions. (Your business transactions are shown on the supporting documents just discussed.) Business transactions are ordinarily summarized in books called journals and ledgers. You can buy them over the Internet and at your local stationery or office supply store. A journal is a book where you record each business transaction shown on your supporting documents. You may have to keep separate journals for transactions that occur frequently. A ledger is a book that contains the totals from all of your journals. It is organized into different accounts. Whether you keep journals and ledgers and how you keep them depends on the type of business you are in. For example, a recordkeeping system for a small business might include the following items:

- Business checkbook.
- Daily summary of cash receipts.
- Monthly summary of cash receipts.
- Check disbursements journal.
- Depreciation worksheet.
- Employee compensation record.

The business checkbook is explained next. The other items are illustrated later under Recordkeeping System Example . . .

The system you use to record business transactions will be more effective if you follow good recordkeeping practices. For example, record expenses when they occur, and identify the source of recorded receipts. Generally, it is best to record transactions on a daily basis.

Business checkbook. One of the first things you should do when you start a business is open a business checking account. You should keep your business account separate from your personal checking account. The business checkbook is your basic source of information for recording your business expenses. You should deposit all daily receipts in your business checking account. You should check your account for errors by reconciling it. See Reconciling the checking account ,

later. Consider using a checkbook that allows enough space to identify the source of deposits as business income, personal funds, or loans. You should also note on the deposit slip the source of the deposit and keep copies of all slips. You should make all payments by check to document business expenses. Write checks payable to yourself only when making withdrawals from your business for personal use. Avoid writing checks payable to cash. If you must write a check for cash to pay a business expense, include the receipt for the cash payment in your records. If you cannot get a receipt for a cash payment, you should make an adequate explanation in your records at the time of payment. . Use the business account for business purposes only. Indicate the source of deposits and the type of expense in the checkbook. .

2 · THE CALL — COPY-PASTABLE, WITH THE REAL VALUES IN IT

```
curl -sS --compressed "https://www.irs.gov/publications/p583"
```

Fetched 2026-09-06 16:40:23Z · 436,282 bytes · SHA-256
 8774973ddaaba92c202cec1feaf93caae8d38662a0a0c866a42d236d0cb46000

3 · THE DERIVATION — WHAT HAPPENS BETWEEN THE TWO

The response is turned into plain text: an XML or HTML document has its inline tags closed up and its block tags turned into a space, a PDF is read page by page. Both sides are then folded the same way — Unicode normalised, and the typographic quotes and dashes publishers vary between renderings mapped to their plain forms. **Nothing else is changed.** The stored text either occurs in the publisher's document or it does not.

4 · THE INDEPENDENT SOURCE — CAPTURED, NOT SUMMARISED

The publisher's own words around the match, quoted verbatim out of the bytes whose hash is printed above. **A reader re-fetches that URL, recomputes the hash, and gets the same digits** — which is a check a photograph cannot offer.

```
...97-22, available at IRS.gov/Tax-Exempt-Bonds/Revenue-Procedures. Supporting Documents Purchases, sales, payroll, and other transactions you have in your business generate supporting documents. Supporting documents include sales slips, paid bills, invoices, receipts, deposit slips, and canceled checks. These documents contain information you need to record in your books. It is important to keep these doc...
```

5 · THE COMPARISON

ours	(ask.brief → IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Supporting Documents&q)
	6,809 characters
theirs	(https://www.irs.gov/publications/p583)
	6,809 of them found, verbatim, in the document fetched above
diff	none

TIED — exact once whitespace is ignored, which is declared below

Every passage on this desk

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(1)	1,163	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(2)	683	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(3)	353	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(4)	598	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(4)(i)	551	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(4)(ii)	307	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(4)(iii)	308	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(b)(1)	251	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(b)(2)	292	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)	200	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)(i)	586	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)(ii)	1,784	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)(iii)	672	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)(iv)	1,034	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(2)	169	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(3)	525	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(d)(1)	870	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(d)(2)	189	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(d)(3)	393	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(1)	608	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)	442	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(i)	129	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(ii)	1,262	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(iii)	1,570	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(iv)	641	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(v)	342	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(vi)	261	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(vii)	658	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(viii)	200	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)	335	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(i)	1,121	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(ii)	213	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(iii)	904	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(iv)	207	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(v)	1,478	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(vi)	198	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(4)	1,282	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)	122	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(i)	1,074	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(ii)	830	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(iii)	1,348	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(iv)	2,032	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(v)	954	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Bookkeeping System"	3,453	spacing
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Kinds of Records To Keep"	3,109	spacing
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Reconciling the checking account" – a bank charge the books do not have	301	elided
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Reconciling the checking account" – what the books are updated for	2,683	spacing
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Reconciling the checking account" – what the statement did not yet include	333	elided
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Supporting Documents"	6,809	spacing

The sources, and that they can disagree with us

- **S1** — Treasury Regulation § 1.446-1 — General rule for methods of accounting
<https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-01-01/title-26.xml?section=1.446-1>
- **S2** — IRS Publication 583 (12/2024) — Starting a Business and Keeping Records
<https://www.irs.gov/publications/p583>

Not one of these is ours. None is a cache, a fixture or a second copy of our own record — which is the test the tie-out skill puts first: **could this disagree with me?** Each one can, and two of them did.

How to run this yourself

Every step below has the real values already in it. Nothing here needs me.

1 · RE-RUN THE WHOLE CHECK

```
cd desk && python -B tools/tieout.py
```

It fetches every source live and writes tie-outs/findings.json. Expect it to take a few minutes: it pauses between requests rather than hammering the publishers.

2 · REBUILD THESE DOCUMENTS FROM THAT RUN

```
cd desk && python -B tools/tieout_exhibit.py
```

3 · CHECK ONE LINE BY HAND, WITHOUT EITHER SCRIPT

Take any row in the roster, fetch its URL, and look for the text yourself:

```
curl -sS --compressed "https://www.irs.gov/publications/p583" | shasum -a 256
```

If that hash matches the one printed with the exemplar above, you are reading the same bytes this document read. Then search the document for the passage — the desk prints it

under that citation in the brief:

```
cd desk && python -B -c "import sys; sys.path.insert(0,'.'); import ask, record, pathlib; \
print(ask.brief('show me', record.load(pathlib.Path('desks/cash-and-bank'))))" | less
```

What it found

Nothing, and that sentence had to be earned three times over. All 531 passages the seven desks hand an answering agent are, today, what the publisher publishes: **0 differs, 0 could not**. The run this morning said 533 and two; the one before it said 88 differences. What changed in between is the record and the checker, and both are worth reading before this figure is believed.

The three findings this run closed, each fixed in the record rather than in the check.

- **Right text, wrong link — three passages.** The rewards desk stored § 6041, § 6041A, § 6050W and § 6071 under ONE source whose recorded URL is the House's granule for **§ 6041 only**. All four bodies were **verbatim correct**, so nothing served was ever wrong and no test in the repository could have seen it — a reader following the citation for three of the four simply landed on a page that did not contain it. **Only opening the link finds this.** Split into four sources, four URLs, each verified live; and the record now has a test comparing the URL a citation is really on with the URL its source claims.
- **A partial quotation that did not say it was one.** Publication 583's sentence has two branches and the cash desk stored the second without marking the omission. The split is right — the branches have opposite answers, which is the defect #264 found — but an answerer could not tell a branch had been removed. Marked now with [. . .], and the mark is CHECKED rather than excused: every segment must appear in the live document, in order.
- **A publisher's interface text inside a quotation.** irs.gov appends the word **PDF** to links that point at PDFs, and one sits mid-sentence on the tangible-property page. Ours dropped it. This was judged in our favour this morning and left; it is the same unmarked omission as Pub 583, and it is marked now. It was the last difference in the corpus.

What "nothing" is worth here. Three of the 531 tied only because a marked omission was checked segment by segment, and 13 tied only once whitespace was ignored. Both are declared, both are counted on each desk's own sheet, and neither is silently folded into the headline. A clean run that hides how it got clean is the thing this exhibit exists not to be.

What I got wrong

The first run reported 88 differences and 34 of them were mine. The extractor replaced every markup tag with a space, so eCFR's election</I>—(1) came back as election - (1) and 601.601(d)(2)(ii)(<I>b</I>) as (b). A checker that invents differences is worse than no checker, because somebody goes and "fixes" the record to match it. Inline tags now close up and only block tags become a space.

Then it reported 18, and 16 of those were mine too. pypdf reads a kerned two-column IRS page as You and hyphenates information across a line break, and irs.gov puts block markup inside a sentence. Those are rendering artefacts of the extractor, not differences in what was published — so the comparison now runs twice, and the exhibit says which pass carried each line rather than quietly folding them together.

I could not capture the sources as photographs, and the skill asks for photographs.

This machine's browser cannot reach the publishers even when pointed at the egress proxy — ERR_CONNECTION_RESET — while the HTTP client reaches them fine. Attempted, failed, recorded. What is here instead is the document itself: its SHA-256, its length, the moment it was fetched and the publisher's own words quoted around each match. For text that is the stronger evidence, because a reader can recompute the hash and a screenshot cannot be re-verified at all.

What this does not prove

- **It proves the words, not the reading.** That § 1.263(a)-1(f)(1)(ii)(D) says \$500 is now established. Whether \$500 is the number that governs a client is a question about Notice 2015-82 and about the firm's election, and no fetch settles it.
- **It proves containment, not completeness.** The check asks whether our passage occurs in the publisher's document. It does not ask whether we stored the *whole* of what that citation covers — a passage could be a true fragment of a paragraph whose second half changes its meaning. Publication 583 above is exactly that failure caught by accident, not by design.
- **The whitespace-ignoring pass can hide a genuinely missing space.** 13 lines tied only on that pass. Each is named in the roster as spacing so nobody has to take it on trust.
- **The regulations were fetched as of 2026-01-01, not today.** eCFR's versioner refuses a future date and this is the last date known good on it. A regulation amended between that date and now would not show here.
- **One reading, not two.** The skill asks for a second rendering where one exists — the XML and the rendered page, the PDF and the HTML. Only one rendering per source was read. A digit or a word wrong in *both* our copy and the one rendering we read would pass.
- **Nothing here touches whether a desk answers well.** This is about the authority it is given. A desk with a perfect corpus can still reason badly from it, and that is what the scoreboard is for.